

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2018

Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 25)

- A. 1 point for each correct cell. (max 12)
- B. 2 points for each correct answer. (max 4)
 - 1 point with one wrong word.
- C. 2 points for each correct escutcheon. (max 4)
 - 1 point with one error.
- D. 5 points for a perfect answer.
 - 1 point for general clarity.
 - 1 point for syntax.
 - 1 point for shapes.
 - 1 point for colours.
 - 1 point for relationships.
 - Don't expect the technical terms used in the explanation below.

a.	description	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
	blazon	F	D	K	I	L	J	A	G	B	E	H	C	
b.	M	Argent two chevrons sable between three roses gules												
	N	Gules a chevron sable between two annulets azure impaling azure three crosses crosslet argent one one one												
c.	1.							2.						

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Commentary

(Note that much of this is not required to solve the problem - however, for the sake of completeness I will try to explain everything)

The syntax of a blazon description

Field partition	Field colour(s) (<i>tincture</i>)	Ordinary charges (bands)	Mobile charges (symbols)
0 (nothing) <i>Per pale</i> <i>Per fess</i> <i>Per chevron</i> <i>Per bend</i> <i>Quarterly</i>	<i>Argent</i> <i>Or</i> <i>Azure</i> <i>Gules</i> <i>Vert</i> <i>Sable</i>	<i>Fess</i> <i>Chevron</i> <i>Bend</i> <i>Bend sinister</i> <i>Cross</i> <i>Chief</i>	<i>Rose</i> <i>Annulet</i> <i>Roundel</i> <i>Cross crosslet</i> <i>Lozenge</i> <i>Gouttes</i>

- If the field is partitioned, the tinctures are described left-to-right and top-to-bottom.
- The field can also be checky, in which case the colours involved are placed straight afterwards.

Variation of ordinaries

- Ordinaries can be embattled or indented to vary their shape.

Tincture of charges

- The tincture of charges is placed after the charge (i.e. a rose sable is a black rose).
- If a charge is counterchanged, it swaps the colours of the field behind it (e.g. if the field was partitioned into azure and vert, the part of the charge in the vert section would be azure and the part in the azure section would be vert).

Location of mobile charges

- When a mobile charge is on an ordinary, the ordinary is preceded by *on* (e.g. on a bend sable two lozenges vert)
- Otherwise, the ordinary can be between the mobile charges or the exact location can be specified (in dexter chief a roundel sable = a black roundel in the top-left). Note that dexter refers to the left of the escutcheon and sinister to the right.
- If there are multiple mobile charges and their orientation relative to each other needs to be described, the tincture is followed by the number of charges in each row (so 5 gold rings could be arranged in a row of 2 and a row of 3, in which case it would be five annulets or two three, or a row of 2, then 1, then 2, in which case it would be five annulets or two one two).

Quarterly

- The 4 quarters are numbered 1-4, with 1 and 3 being identical and 2 and 4 being identical also. The first tincture is for 1&4, the second for 2&3.
- If more needs to be described, the syntax is Quarterly 1 & 4 _____, 2 & 3 _____

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Impaling

- Two sets of arms can be combined into one by impaling them together. This takes blazon description A and description B and puts them together as such: A impaling B

Bordure

- A border can be placed around an escutcheon and it is described like an ordinary but is described last in the blazon system.